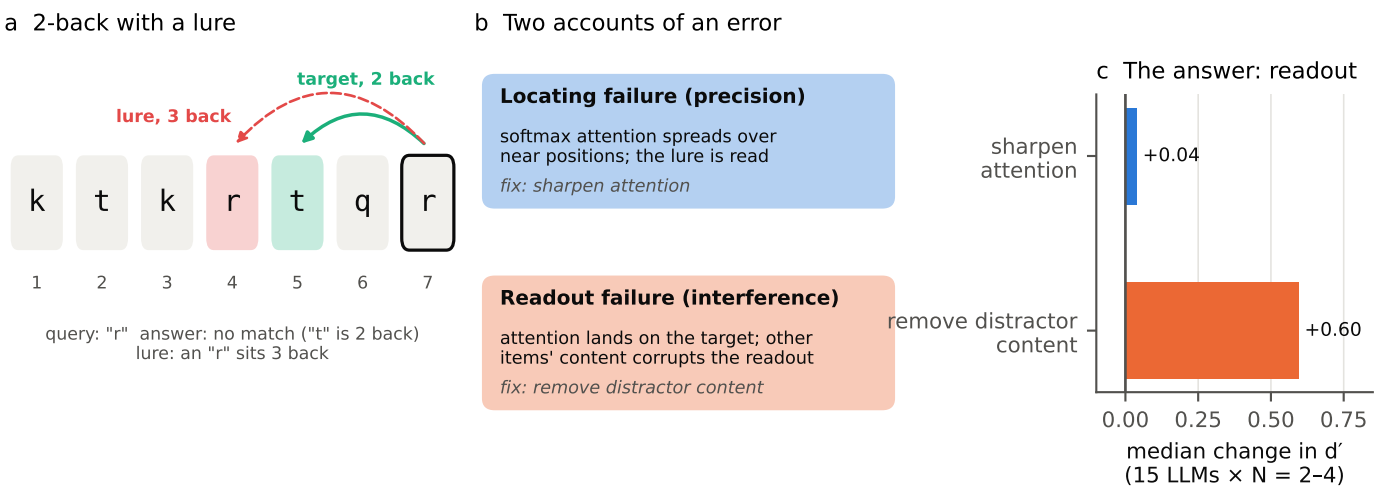
a 2-back with a lure
target, 2 back
lure, 3 back
k t k r t q r
1 2 3 4 5 6 7
query: "r" answer: no match ("t" is 2 back)
lure: an "r" sits 3 back
b Two accounts of an error
Locating failure (precision)
softmax attention spreads over near positions; the lure is read
fix: sharpen attention
Readout failure (interference)
attention lands on the target; other items' content corrupts the readout
fix: remove distractor content
c The answer: readout
sharpen attention
+0.04
remove distractor content
+0.60
0.00 0.25 0.50 0.75
median change in d′
(15 LLMs × N = 2–4)